MILITARY SPECIFICATION

PROPELLANT M26
FOR USE IN CARTRIDGE, ANTI-PERSONNEL
XM581 FOR 106MM RIFLE M40A1

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers M26 Propellant for use in one type of Cartridge designated as Cartridge, 106MM, APERS, XM581, for use in recoilless rifle M40A1.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids, or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-109 - Quality Assurance Terms and Definitions
MIL-STD-652 - Propellants, Solid for Cannons, Requirements and Packing
MIL-STD-1168 - Lot Numbering of Ammunition.

DRAWINGS

ARMY

9210603 - Cartridge, Anti-personnel, XM581, For 106MM Rifle M40A1

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings and publications required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Publications.-The following document forms a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids shall apply.

FSC: 1375

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-23T00:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

CODE OF FEDERAL REGULATIONS

49 CFR 71-90 - Interstate Commerce Commission Rules and Regulations for the Transportation of Explosives and Other Dangerous Articles

(The Interstate Commerce Commission Rules are now a part of the Code of Federal Regulations (1949 Edition and revisions) available from the Superintendent of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C. 20402. Orders for the above publications should cite "49 CFR 71-90 (latest revision).")

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Materials.-The propellant shall be M26, Type I and conforming to the requirements of Standard MIL-STD-652.

3.2 Ballistics.-The propellant, when fired in the weapon, and with the weight of projectile for which it was manufactured, shall comply with the following requirements when tested as specified in 4.3.1.

3.2.1 Velocity and pressure.-At 70 degrees Fahrenheit (^{o}F) a weight of propellant shall be charge assessed to comply with the prescribed service velocity of 1440 feet per second (438.9 meters per second) without exceeding a maximum rated pressure of 11,100 pounds per square inch (psi), piezo equivalent pressure (pep).

3.2.2 Uniformity of velocity.-The standard deviation of velocity for the lot at 70°F shall not exceed 12.5 feet per second (3.81 meters per second).

3.2.3 Permissable individual maximum pressure.-No individual maximum pressure shall be greater than 12,800 psi pep (115 percent of the rated maximum pressure of the gun).

3.3 Workmanship.-The best commercial practices shall be used in the formulation of propellant furnished under this specification, and all other applicable documents. The propellant and its standard ingredients shall be protected from the action of direct sunlight and acid fumes. No reground propellant or nitrocellulose shall be used in the manufacture of propellant procured under this specification unless otherwise specified.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-23T00:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 General quality assurance provisions.-Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves thr right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements. Reference shall be made to Standard MIL-STD-109 in order to define the terms used herein. The provisions of Specification MIL-A-2550 shall apply.

4.1.1 Submission of product.-At the time the completed lot of product is submitted to the Government for acceptance the contractor shall supply the following information accompanied by a certificate which attests that the information provided is correct and applicable to the product being submitted:

a. A statement that the lot complies with all quality assurance provisions specified within this specification.
b. Number of batches of product inspected.
c. Results obtained, by defect code, for all inspections performed.
d. Drawing, specification number and date together with an identification and date of changes.
e. Certificates of conformance on all material purchased by the contractor when such material is controlled by Government or commercial specifications referenced in any of the contractual documents.
f. Number of pounds in the lot.
g. Date submitted.
h. Eight copies of propellant description sheet AMC Form 1047 (OO Form 1204) containing the applicable data (see 6.7).

The certificate shall be signed by a responsible agent of the certifying organization. The initial certificate submitted shall be substantiated by evidence of the agent's authority to bind his principal. Substantiation of the agent's authority will not be required with subsequent certificates unless, during the course of the contract, this authority is vested in another agent of the certifying organization.

4.1.2 Government verification.-Using the contractor's written quality assurance procedure, this detail specification, the applicable drawings and other contractual documents as a guide,

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-23T00:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

the Government inspector shall verify at unscheduled intervals all quality assurance operations performed by the contractor. Verification will be performed to the extent necessary to assure compliance with the contractual requirements. Severity of Government inspection of individual characteristics will be directly related to the seriousness of the classification assigned. In no instance will a characteristic classified "critical" be accepted solely on the basis of the contractor's records.

4.2 Inspection provisions

4.2.1 Lot formation.-A lot shall consist of one or more batches of M26 propellant produced by one manufacturer, in accordance with the same specification, and same specification revision under one continuous set of operating conditions. Each lot shall consist of that quantity of M26 propellant which has been subjected to the same unit chemical or physical process intended to make the final product homogeneous. The criteria and procedures for the assignment of lot numbers shall be in accordance with Standard MIL-STD-1168.

4.2.2 Testing (see 4.3)

4.2.2.1 Ballistics (see 3.2).-A composite sample of 400 pounds of the propellant shall be prepared by selecting equal quantities of the propellant from at least 10 randomly selected containers. When lots are comprised of 10 containers or less, each container will be sampled. The prepared sample shall be used for charge establishment, determining uniformity of velocity and determining maximum pressure.

4.2.2.1.1 Pressure (see 3.2.1).-Critical defect, Code No. 01001 (see 6.4).-The lot of propellant shall be rejected if it fails to meet the applicable requirement.

4.2.2.1.2 Uniformity of velocity (see 3.2.1 and 3.2.2) Major defect, Code No. 02001.-If the product of the factor 0.73 times the velocity standard deviation of the test rounds exceeds the applicable requirement, the lot shall be rejected.

4.2.2.1.3 Permissable individual maximum pressure (see 3.2.3) Critical defect, Code No. 03001.-The maximum pressure calculated for the assessed charge weight for the lot, plus four (4) times the standard deviation of the maximum pressure obtained, shall not exceed the applicable requirement (see 6.2).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-23T00:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.2.2.2 Retest.-If for any reason the proof director considers that the test conditions have detrimentally affected the test results, he shall declare the results invalid and perform a new test on additional charges as required.

4.3 Test methods and procedures

4.3.1 Ballistics.-These tests shall be conducted at a Government proving ground in accordance with the applicable Ordnance Proof Manual. A weight of charge shall be calculated, from charge velocity and charge-pressure curves representing actual firing data, to give prescribed service velocity. Proof projectiles of the correct weight and rotating band configuration shall be used when testing is conducted utilizing the 106MM Rifle.

4.3.1.1 Uniformity series.-The propellant shall be conditioned to 70°F plus or minus 2°F for at least 16 hours and shall be fired within a minimum time after removal from the conditioning chamber. A ten (10) round uniformity series shall be fired for evaluation of the production lots and the velocity mean and standard deviation shall be calculated after reducing results to standard conditions and pressure. In addition, the mean and standard deviation of the maximum pressures (after correcting to standard conditions and assessed charge weight) shall be reported as piezo equivalent pressure. (reference shall be made to dwg. 9210603).

4.3.2 Extreme temperature firings (see 6.6)

4.3.2.1 Conditioned rounds (minus 65 degrees F).-For informational purposes only, a ten (10) round uniformity series shall be fired on rounds which were conditioned for a minimum of 24 hours, at minus 65 degrees F. before firing. These rounds will be inert loaded except for propellant system. This test will be performed on the first 5 lots which have been accepted. Firings will be performed within a minimum time after removal from the conditioning chamber.

4.3.2.2 Conditioned rounds (160 degrees F).-For informational purposes only, a ten (10) round uniformity series shall be fired on rounds which were conditioned for a minimum of 15 days at 160 degrees F. before firing. These rounds will be inert loaded except for propellant system. This test will be performed on the first five lots which have been accepted.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-23T00:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Firing of the first lot, of the five lots submitted, will be performed within a minimum time after removal from the conditioning chamber. The remaining four (4) lots will, however, (after removal from the conditioning chamber) be subjected to ambient temperature for a period of sixteen hours minimum prior to firing.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packing and marking.-Packing and marking shall be in accordance with Standard MIL-STD-652.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data.-Procurement documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number and date of this specification.
b. Packing required (see 5.1)
c. Process.-Details of the manufacturing process and the equipment used by the contractor will be submitted to the procuring activity in writing prior to commencement of manufacture.

6.2 Standard deviation.-The standard deviation shall be calculated with N-1 as the divisor in a standard statistical technique equivalent to that shown in Standard MIL-STD-414, Section B, Example B-1.

6.3 Submission of test data.-In addition to the normal distribution of records, when the propellant is procured by the Department of the Army, one copy of all ballistic test data, AMC Form 1060 will be forwarded to: Commanding Officer, Picatinny Arsenal, ATTN: SMUPA-ND2 and one copy to ATTN: SMUPA-DE2, Dover, New Jersey.

6.4 Inspection code numbers.-The five digit code numbers assigned to the inspections herein are to facilitate future data collection and analysis by the Government.

6.5 Intended use.-It is intended that the item of this specification will be used in Cartridge, 106MM, XM581.

6.6 Extreme temperature firings.-These tests will be performed to obtain additional information on the characteristics of the propellant at extreme temperature. Results of the informational testings will have no effect upon the acceptability of the lots involved.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-23T00:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

6.7 Submission of AMC Form 1047.-Information contained in propellant description sheet, AMC Form 1047, need not be resubmitted in the form of a certificate provided the provisions regarding certifying of responsible agents is adhered to (see 4.1.1.)

Custodian:
Army-MU

Preparing activity:
Army-MU

Project Number: 1375-A951

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-23T00:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-23T00:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

COMMENTS ON ANY SPECIFICATION REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

IS THE SPECIFICATION RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO IF "YES", IN WHAT WAY?

REMARKS *(Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this specification. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity)*

MITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and activity)*	DATE

FORM 1426 REPLACES NAVSHIPS FORM 4863, WHICH IS OBSOLETE C-0379

SPECIFICATION ANALYSIS SHEET

Form Approved
Budget Bureau No. 119-R004

INSTRUCTIONS

This sheet is to be filled out by personnel either Government or contractor, involved in the use of the specification in procurement of products for ultimate use by the Department of Defense. This sheet is provided for obining information on the use of this specification which will insure that suitable products can be procured with a nimum amount of delay and at the least cost. Comments and the return of this form will be appreciated. Fold on nes on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity *(as indicated on reverse hereof)*.

ECIFICATION

GANIZATION *(Of submitter)*	CITY AND STATE

NTRACT NO.	QUANTITY OF ITEMS PROCURED	DOLLAR AMOUNT
		$

TERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

HAS ANY PART OF THE SPECIFICATION CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-23T00:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

FOLD

DEPARTMENT OF THE NAVY

POSTAGE AND FEES PAID
NAVY DEPARTMENT

OFFICIAL BUSINESS

Commander
Frankford Arsenal
Attn: SARFA-MDM
Philadelphia, PA 19137

FOLD

4

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-23T00:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-23T00:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.